

আমি বলি, আমি সংযুক্ত হই [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

Blu Foundation | Class 4 | Ages 9–10 Version: 1.0 DRAFT | Date: June 2026

**Curriculum Team Note:** Sections marked [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION] require review by the Blu Foundation Bengali language consultant before final print. Sections marked [FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED] require sign-off from the Executive Director before distribution.

## A Note to Students

Hello, Class 4!

You talk every day — to your friends, your family, your teachers. But did you know that *how* you speak matters just as much as *what* you say?

This book is for you. It will help you:

- Speak honestly and kindly, even when things are hard
- Listen so well that your friends feel truly heard
- Be safe, responsible, and kind in the online world
- Stand up for others when they need help

In this book you will meet two students — **Mitu** and **Rafi**. Sometimes they make mistakes. Sometimes they do things really well. You will learn from both.

At the end of each chapter, you will make a small promise to yourself. These promises — kept one day at a time — are how you grow into a person people love to talk to, trust, and rely on.

You already have everything you need to do this. Let's begin.

## A Note to Parents [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

[NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION — Full section below provided in English for translation]

Dear Parents and Guardians,

Your child is beginning a course on communication etiquette and digital responsibility. At Blu Foundation, we believe good communication is one of the most important life skills a child can develop — and that it begins at home.

Each chapter of this textbook includes a **Parent Corner** — a short, practical suggestion for how you can reinforce what your child is learning. These are not homework tasks. They are simple conversations and habits that take just a few

minutes but make a lasting difference.

You do not need any special knowledge to support your child. You only need to:

1. Ask questions and listen when they share what they learned
2. Share your own experiences — times you spoke kindly, times you wish you had listened better, times you made a mistake online and corrected it
3. Take their online experiences seriously — both the good and the difficult ones

If your child comes to you and tells you about bullying, a hurtful message, or something uncomfortable they saw online, please listen first. Children who know their parents will listen — not punish — are far more likely to ask for help when they truly need it.

Thank you for your partnership. Together, we help your child thrive.

— The Blu Foundation Team

## A Note to Teachers

This textbook is designed for Class 4 students (ages 9–10). It covers five interconnected themes: assertive communication, empathic listening, digital literacy, digital etiquette, and cyberbullying prevention. The pedagogical approach is **case-study and scenario-based**: students encounter realistic characters and situations, analyse responses, and practise alternatives.

### Pedagogical principles:

- **Active learning first.** Each chapter opens with a story, not a definition. Let students respond to the story before you introduce the vocabulary.
- **Non-judgement.** Students may recognise themselves in passive, aggressive, or unkind behaviours. Normalise growth, not shame.
- **Roleplay is essential.** The writing activities are preparation for roleplay. Do not skip the performance step — embodied practice builds transferable skill.
- **Cultural grounding.** This curriculum is written for Bangladeshi children in a Bangladeshi context. References to Islamic principles are included where appropriate as ethical anchors, not as exclusionary content. Teachers should exercise sensitivity with students of other faiths.
- **Screen time and digital use.** Do not require students to disclose their personal social media accounts or messaging habits. Keep all digital discussions general and scenario-based.

**Timing guidance:** Each chapter is designed for one 40–50 minute class session. The activity at the end of each chapter can extend into a second session if needed.

**Materials needed:** Exercise books or printed activity sheets, coloured pens or pencils (optional), a timer for the listening activity in Chapter 2.

# CHAPTER 1

# Words That Build — Communication Styles

সংযোগ গড়ে তোলা কথা — যোগাযোগের ধরন [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

**Virtue: Respect + Honesty** | সম্মান + সত্যতা [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

**Learning Objective:** Students will distinguish between assertive, aggressive, and passive communication and choose assertive language in five everyday situations.

## The Story: Mitu and the Group Project

It was Thursday afternoon, and Class 4 was working on their science project. Ms Fahmida had put them into groups of four. Mitu had worked hard the night before — she had a whole page of ideas.

"Let me share something," Mitu said, opening her notebook. "What if we make a model of the water cycle using plastic bottles and—"

"That's stupid," Farhan interrupted, barely looking up. "Nobody wants to make a bottle thing. We're doing a poster."

Mitu felt her face go hot. She looked at Lena, the fourth group member, hoping she would say something. But Lena was staring at her desk, saying nothing, even though Mitu had seen her nodding along to the bottle idea a moment ago.

For a moment, Mitu wanted to shout back: *"MY idea is not stupid, YOURS is!"* But she took a breath instead.

"Farhan," she said, keeping her voice calm, "I feel frustrated when my ideas aren't listened to. I think each of us should get a chance to share one idea before we decide. Can we do that?"

Farhan looked surprised. He was used to people either fighting back or going quiet. He shrugged. "Fine."

One by one, everyone shared. It turned out Lena had an idea that combined the poster with a small model. They agreed on it. Mitu's bottle idea contributed to the model section. Everyone left the group feeling that they had been heard — including Farhan.

**What just happened?** Let's look at the three ways people responded in that story.

**Farhan** used **aggressive communication**. He spoke loudly, dismissed someone else's idea without listening, and used a hurtful word ("stupid"). Aggressive communication wins the moment but loses the relationship. It shuts people down and stops good ideas from being shared.

**Lena** used **passive communication**. She stayed silent, even though she had thoughts and feelings. She did not stand up for Mitu or for herself. Passive communication feels safe, but it means your voice is never heard — and people can't connect with someone they never hear from.

**Mitu** used **assertive communication**. She was honest — she said she was frustrated. She was kind — she didn't attack Farhan. And she was constructive — she suggested a solution. Assertive communication is not a Western idea or a foreign one. In fact, Islam teaches us the same principle. The Quran (Surah 4:63) speaks of words that "penetrate the soul" — meaning words that are true, direct, and reach the heart without cruelty. Assertive communication is the language of respect.

## The Three Styles: A Quick Guide

| Style             | What it sounds like                                        | How others feel         | Long-term result           |
|-------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|----------------------------|
| <b>Aggressive</b> | "You're wrong! Your idea is terrible! Stop talking!"       | Hurt, scared, defensive | People avoid you           |
| <b>Passive</b>    | (Silence. Looking down. Nodding when you disagree.)        | Confused, ignored       | Your needs are never met   |
| <b>Assertive</b>  | "I think my idea could work because... Can we discuss it?" | Respected, heard        | Trust and cooperation grow |

### Activity: "What Would You Say?"

Read each situation. In your exercise book, write an **assertive** response — honest AND kind. Remember: you are not being rude, and you are not staying silent. You are speaking the truth with respect.

**Situation 1:** Your classmate keeps borrowing your pencil and eraser without asking. Today they took your ruler too, without a word.

*What would you say assertively?*

*(Example of what NOT to say — aggressive: "Stop touching my stuff, you thief!") (Example of what NOT to say — passive: Say nothing. Fume silently.)*

**Situation 2:** Your friend said something in front of the whole class that embarrassed you. You're upset. Later, you're alone with them.

*What would you say assertively?*

**Situation 3:** Your teacher gives an instruction that you think is different from what she said last week. You are confused and think she may have made a mistake.

*What would you say assertively? (Remember: respectful and honest — not dismissive!)*

**Situation 4:** You are standing in the queue for water at the tap. Someone walks up and steps right in front of you.

*What would you say assertively?*

**Situation 5:** You need help understanding the maths homework but you don't know the other students in your row very well.

*What would you say assertively?*

### My Commitment

Write this in your exercise book and sign your name.

*"I will practise speaking assertively — **honest AND kind** — every day. I will not shout to be heard, and I will not stay silent when I have something important to say."*

**Name:** \_\_\_\_\_ **Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Teacher Notes — Chapter 1

**Before the activity:** Read the case study aloud together, or ask three students to play Mitu, Farhan, and Lena. Do not summarise the moral first — ask students: *"What did each person do? How do you think Lena felt? Why did Farhan look surprised?"*

**During the activity:** Students write their responses individually first (5 minutes), then share with a partner. After sharing, invite 2–3 students to read their assertive responses aloud for each situation.

**Roleplay (strongly recommended):** After writing responses, run the roleplay. Situation 1 and Situation 4 are particularly good for quick roleplay — they are concrete and physical. Rotate roles so students experience both speaking assertively and receiving assertive communication.

**Common misconceptions to address:**

- "Assertive = bossy." Clarify: assertive language invites dialogue; bossy language closes it.
- "Being quiet is being polite." Clarify: there is a difference between choosing silence (wise restraint) and using silence because you are afraid. This course is about building the confidence to choose.

**Assessment checkpoint:** Can each student correctly label a sample statement as aggressive, passive, or assertive? Use three quick written examples as an exit check.

## Parent Corner [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

[NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION — English below for translation]

This week, your child learned about three communication styles: aggressive, passive, and assertive. Assertive communication means speaking honestly AND kindly — not too loudly, not in silence.

**This week, ask your child:**

*"Did you speak assertively today? Tell me about it."*

Listen to their answer without correcting them. If they described a situation where they stayed passive or got a little aggressive, say: *"That happens to all of us. What could you have said instead?"* Help them find the words together.

You can also share a time from your own day when you had to speak honestly to someone, and how you found the right words.

# CHAPTER 2

## Listening to Understand — Empathic Listening

বোঝার জন্য শোনা — সহানুভূতিশীল মনোযোগ [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

**Virtue: Empathy** | সহানুভূতি [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

**Learning Objective:** Students will use empathic listening techniques in at least one peer conversation per week.

### The Story: Rafi and the Friend Who Needed to Be Heard

Rafi's friend Hasan came to sit beside him at break time. He looked upset — his shoulders were low and he wasn't eating his tiffin.

"Rafi, can I tell you something?"

"Yeah, what?" Rafi said, his eyes still on his phone screen. He was in the middle of a game.

"It's about my parents," Hasan started. "They keep fighting a lot lately and I feel—"

"Just ignore it," Rafi said, glancing up for half a second. "All parents fight sometimes. It'll be fine."

Hasan stopped talking. He looked at the ground. "Yeah. Okay."

He moved away. He felt worse than before.

Rafi didn't even notice. He went back to his game.

A few benches away, another student — Priya — had seen what happened. She came and sat beside Hasan.

She put her phone in her pocket.

She looked at him.

"Hey. What's going on? You looked like you wanted to say something."

Hasan started again. This time, Priya didn't look away. She nodded slowly. She said "mm-hmm" when he paused. She didn't offer advice or solutions. She didn't say "at least..." or "just..."

When Hasan finished, Priya said: "That sounds really hard. I'm sorry you're going through that."

Then she asked: "What do you need right now? Do you want to talk more, or do you just want company?"

Hasan took a breath. "Just company, I think."

"Okay," Priya said. And they sat together quietly.

Hasan went back to class feeling lighter. Not because his problem was solved — it wasn't — but because someone had truly heard him.

**What made the difference?** Rafi had *heard* Hasan's words, but he had not *listened*. He was distracted, he made assumptions, and he jumped straight to advice without understanding what Hasan actually needed. Priya did the opposite. She listened to understand, not to respond.

Empathic listening is one of the most powerful gifts you can give another person. It says: *You matter. Your feelings are real. I am here.*

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## The 6 Skills of Empathic Listening

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**Skill 1: Put away distractions.** Your phone, your pencil, your own thoughts about what to say next — set them aside. Full attention is the first act of listening.

**Skill 2: Make eye contact.** Not a stare — a gentle, steady look that says, *I see you*. In our culture, how we make eye contact may vary by age or relationship, but giving someone your gaze tells them they have your attention.

**Skill 3: Use small signals to show you're following.** A slow nod. A quiet "mm-hmm." These small sounds say: *I'm still here. Keep going.*

**Skill 4: Don't plan your response while the other person is speaking.** When we start thinking about what we want to say, we stop hearing what *they* are saying. Notice if your mind wanders to your own reply, and gently bring it back.

**Skill 5: Reflect back.** When they finish, say what you heard — in your own words. "So what I'm hearing is that you felt left out when they didn't invite you — is that right?" This gives the other person a chance to say yes or to correct you.

**Skill 6: Ask: "What do you need from me right now?"** This is perhaps the most important question. Sometimes people need advice. Often they just need to feel heard. When you ask, you let *them* decide — and that is the deepest form of respect.

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## Peer Discussion Activity: The 2-Minute Listen

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In pairs:

- **Partner A** shares a small problem — it can be real or made up. (Example: "I'm stressed about a test." / "I had a fight with my cousin." / "I'm nervous about something.") Partner A speaks for **2 minutes**.
- **Partner B** only listens. No advice. No "just..." No interruptions. Use all 6 skills.
- When the 2 minutes are up, **Partner B** reflects back: "*So what I heard is...*"
- Then **Partner B** asks: "*What do you need from me right now?*"
- **Swap roles.**

Debrief (whole class):

- What did your listening partner do that made you feel heard?
  - What was the hardest part of listening without giving advice?
  - Did anyone notice their mind wandering to their own response?
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## My Commitment

"This week, I will listen to one person **fully** — phone away, eyes on them, heart open — before I respond."

**Name:** \_\_\_\_\_ **Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Teacher Notes — Chapter 2

**Reading the case study:** Assign three roles — Rafi, Hasan, and Priya. Read dramatically. Pause after Hasan says "Yeah. Okay." and moves away. Ask: "*How did Hasan feel? Why? What did Rafi do wrong?*" Emphasise that Rafi was not cruel — he just wasn't present. This is a subtle distinction and a common one.

**Timing the activity:** Use a timer. The 2-minute rule is strict. Students will find it challenging not to jump in with advice — that difficulty is the lesson. Do not skip the debrief.

### Common pitfalls in the activity:

- Students giving advice during the 2 minutes — gently stop them and remind them to just listen.
- Students not knowing what to share — have 5 "made up" prompts written on the board as options.
- Students finishing before 2 minutes — encourage them to say "tell me more" and keep going.

**Extension (if time allows):** Ask: *When do you most want someone to just listen to you — not fix, not advise?* Brief discussion in the whole class.

**Assessment checkpoint:** At the end of class, students write one sentence completing this prompt: "*Empathic listening means* \_\_\_\_\_." Collect and review before the next session.

## Parent Corner [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

### [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION — English below for translation]

This week, your child learned about empathic listening — listening to understand, not just to reply.

### A simple practice for this week:

When your child comes to you with a problem — big or small — try to listen fully before offering a solution. Put down whatever you're doing for just a moment. Make eye contact. When they finish, say: "*So what I'm hearing is...*" and reflect back what they said. Then ask: "*What do you need from me — advice, or just someone to listen?*"

You may be surprised by how much this small change means to your child.

## CHAPTER 3

# The Online World — Introduction to Digital Life

## অনলাইন জগৎ — ডিজিটাল জীবনের পরিচয় [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

**Virtue: Responsibility** | দায়িত্ব [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

**Learning Objective:** Students will name 3 differences between online and offline communication and their implications.

### The Story: The Photo Mitu Didn't Think About

It was lunch break. Mitu and her friends were playing in the courtyard when Nadia tripped over her own feet and stumbled — not badly, she wasn't hurt — but it looked funny. Mitu had her older sister's phone that day. Without thinking, she took a quick photo.

That evening, she posted it to the class group with a laughing emoji.

Within minutes, fifteen students had responded — laughing emojis, funny captions, more comments.

Nadia saw it. She felt her face burn. She wanted to disappear. The photo stayed up. Even when Mitu deleted it the next morning — after a teacher spoke to her — screenshots already existed on three other phones.

The following week, Nadia was quiet at school. She didn't want to come to lunch. She felt like everyone was watching her and laughing. She hadn't done anything wrong. She had just tripped.

Mitu had not meant to hurt her. She genuinely thought it was funny, just a moment, just online. But that gap — between *"just online"* and *real life* — is one of the most important things you will ever understand.

What happens online is real. The embarrassment is real. The hurt is real. And once something is posted, you cannot fully control where it goes.

Research with students in Bangladesh shows that social media use — when not guided by clear values — can lead to serious social problems, including behaviours that hurt peers and damage relationships [SOURCE\_BD\_13, SOURCE\_BD\_14]. This is not because technology is bad. It is because powerful tools require wise hands.

### 4 Things to Know About Online Life

- 1. Online permanence: once posted, it is very hard to delete.** Even if you delete something, it may have already been screenshotted, forwarded, or saved. Before you post, ask: *"Would I be okay if this stayed online forever?"*
- 2. The permission rule: always ask before sharing photos or videos of others.** This is simple and non-negotiable. If the photo or video includes another person, you ask them first. Even if you think they'll say yes. Even if it seems harmless. Ask.
- 3. Real feelings: online words hurt as much as offline words.** Your brain does not separate an insult received by text from an insult said to your face. Both hurt. Both leave a mark. The fact that there is a screen between you does not reduce the impact.
- 4. Your digital footprint: what you post follows you.** Everything you post, share, or comment is part of your digital footprint — a trail that can be seen by others, now and in the future. Build a footprint you are proud of.

## Digital Scenario Activity

Read each scenario. Circle **GOOD** or **NOT GOOD**. Then, for each NOT GOOD scenario, write one sentence explaining why.

**Scenario 1:** You find a meme that makes fun of one classmate's teeth. You think it's funny because it's "not really about them specifically." You share it in the class group.

**GOOD / NOT GOOD**

If NOT GOOD, why? \_\_\_\_\_

**Scenario 2:** You notice a friend wasn't at school today and seemed upset the last time you spoke. You send them a message: "Hey — I heard you were upset. Are you okay? I'm here if you want to talk."

**GOOD / NOT GOOD**

If NOT GOOD, why? \_\_\_\_\_

**Scenario 3:** You hear a rumour that a classmate cheated on a test. You don't know if it's true, but you forward the message to three friends "so they know."

**GOOD / NOT GOOD**

If NOT GOOD, why? \_\_\_\_\_

**Scenario 4:** Your group finishes a project and takes a photo together. Before posting it, you check with everyone in the photo: "Is it okay if I post this?" Everyone says yes. You post it.

**GOOD / NOT GOOD**

If NOT GOOD, why? \_\_\_\_\_

**Scenario 5:** Someone sends you an angry message. You feel your chest tighten. You immediately type an even longer, angrier reply.

**GOOD / NOT GOOD**

If NOT GOOD, why? \_\_\_\_\_

## My Commitment

"Before I post, share, or forward anything online, I will ask myself three questions:

- **Is it true?**

- *Is it kind?*
- *Is it necessary?*

*If the answer to any of these is no, I will not post it."*

**Name:** \_\_\_\_\_ **Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Teacher Notes — Chapter 3

**Opening discussion (before reading the story):** Ask: *"Who uses a phone sometimes — yours or a family member's? What do you use it for?"* Do not require students to share personal social media details. Keep it general.

**After the story:** Ask: *"What mistake did Mitu make? Was she a bad person? What should she have done differently?"* Push students to separate the person from the action — Mitu is not cruel, but she made a harmful choice. This distinction matters for self-reflection: students who have done similar things can engage without shame.

**During the scenario activity:** Students complete individually (5 minutes), then compare answers with a partner. Discuss any disagreements as a class. There should be clear consensus on Scenarios 1, 3, 5 (NOT GOOD) and Scenarios 2, 4 (GOOD).

**Sensitive handling:** Some students in your class may already have experienced the pain of having a photo shared without their permission, or of being the subject of online ridicule. Create space for this without requiring disclosure. You might say: *"Some of us may have felt Nadia's feeling before. You don't have to share. But hold that feeling as you do the next activity."*

**Assessment checkpoint:** Three key concepts — permanence, permission, digital footprint — named and briefly explained in students' own words.

## Parent Corner [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

[NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION — English below for translation]

This week, your child learned about the online world — how it is both connected to and different from real life, and why responsible digital habits matter.

**A conversation to have this week:**

Please share **3 rules your family uses** (or would like to use) to stay safe and respectful online. These might include: no sharing photos of family members without permission; no use of phones during meals; checking with a parent before joining a new group or app.

If you don't yet have family digital rules, this is a wonderful opportunity to make them together.

## CHAPTER 4

# Be Kind Online — Digital Etiquette

অনলাইনে ভদ্র হও — ডিজিটাল শিষ্টাচার [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

**Virtue: Kindness** | দয়া [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

**Learning Objective:** Students will apply 5 digital etiquette rules to their own online and phone behaviour.

## The Story: Rafi's 10 Minutes

On a Tuesday evening, Rafi received a message in the class group from his classmate Tamim.

*"Rafi you were supposed to bring the chart paper today. Because of you we had to postpone everything. This is typical of you."*

Rafi read it once. Then again. He felt a hot rush in his chest — anger, embarrassment, the urge to defend himself immediately and loudly.

He started typing.

*"Maybe if YOU had reminded me like a normal person instead of—"*

He stopped. His fingers hovered.

He put down the phone.

He waited 10 minutes.

When he came back, he re-read Tamim's message. It was still unfair. But Rafi also remembered — Tamim had been looking stressed all week. His parents were going through something difficult. The message was rude, but maybe it wasn't really *about* chart paper.

Rafi deleted his angry draft. He typed:

*"I'm sorry I forgot the chart paper — that was my mistake and I should have remembered. Are you okay? You seem stressed lately."*

There was a long pause. Then Tamim replied:

*"Yeah. Sorry for snapping. I'm having a rough week."*

*"I know,"* Rafi typed back. *"Want to talk after school?"*

They did. The conflict was resolved — not by Rafi backing down, but by him choosing the right moment and the right words.

**What made the difference?** Rafi knew a powerful truth: the message you send when you are angry is almost never the message you should send. The internet is fast, but wisdom is sometimes slow. That 10-minute gap was where Rafi's kindness lived.

Research shows that online platforms and algorithms shape what young people see as normal behaviour [SOURCE\_BD\_16]. If everyone around us responds to conflict with instant, angry messages, that starts to look like the right way to respond. But it isn't. We each get to decide what is normal in our own lives.

## 5 Rules of Digital Etiquette

**Rule 1: Don't send messages when you're angry. Wait at least 10 minutes.** Angry messages rarely solve anything. They usually make things worse. Write the draft if you need to — but don't send it yet. Sleep on it if the issue is big.

**Rule 2: Use complete words and respectful language.** "ur so funny lol" is very different from "You were really funny today." Take the time to communicate clearly. You don't have to avoid all abbreviations — but important conversations deserve proper sentences.

**Rule 3: Reply within a reasonable time. Ignoring is rude.** If someone sends you a message, they deserve a response. Even if you're busy, even if you don't know what to say, a quick *"I got your message — can I reply properly later?"* shows respect.

**Rule 4: Don't share private conversations without permission.** If someone confides in you by message, that message is private. Screenshotting someone's personal words and sharing them is a serious breach of trust — online and offline.

**Rule 5: If you wouldn't say it to someone's face, don't type it.** This is the simplest test. Read your message aloud as if the person is sitting in front of you. Would you say it? If not, rewrite it.

## Activity: Rewrite These Messages

Below are three rude or careless digital messages. Rewrite each one to be polite, clear, and respectful. Keep the same basic meaning — just change the words and tone.

**Original message 1:** *"ur so boring lol"*

**Your rewrite:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Original message 2:** *"Why didn't u come?? I waited FOREVER. Thanks for nothing"*

**Your rewrite:** \_\_\_\_\_

**Original message 3:** *(In a group chat, responding to someone's suggestion) "That's a dumb idea"*

**Your rewrite:** \_\_\_\_\_

*(Bonus challenge: Write one rude digital message of your own — something you've seen or can imagine — and rewrite it too.)*

## My Commitment

*"I choose to be kind online just as I am in person. When I am angry, I will wait. When I communicate, I will be clear. When someone reaches out to me, I will respond with respect."*

**Name:** \_\_\_\_\_ **Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Teacher Notes — Chapter 4

**Before reading the story:** Ask: *"Has anyone ever sent a message they later wished they hadn't? You don't have to share the details — just a show of hands."* Most hands will go up. Say: *"We've all done it. Today we learn what to do instead."*

**After the story:** Ask: *"What was Rafi's first instinct? What did he do instead? What do you think would have happened if he had sent the angry message?"*

**During the rewrite activity:** Students work individually first (5 minutes), then share rewrites with a partner and compare. Invite 2–3 students to share their rewrite of each message with the class. Discuss: *"What changed? What stayed the same?"*

**Discussion point:** Rule 5 — "If you wouldn't say it to their face, don't type it" — is a powerful anchor. Spend 3–5 minutes discussing why screens sometimes make people bolder in unkind ways. What is it about typing that feels different from speaking? (Distance, anonymity, time — students often have insightful answers.)

**Assessment checkpoint:** Each student writes their own "Digital Etiquette Rule 6" — something they personally commit to that goes beyond the list.

## Parent Corner [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

[NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION — English below for translation]

This week, your child learned 5 rules of digital etiquette — how to communicate online with the same kindness and care they would use in person.

**A practice for this week:**

Sit with your child and look through their messaging habits together — not to check up on them or punish, but to practise. Ask: *"Show me a message you sent this week that you feel good about. Why does it feel good?"* Then ask: *"Is there any message you might reword if you could send it again?"*

This is not about criticism. It is about building the habit of reflection — the pause before the send.

## CHAPTER 5

# Stop Cyberbullying — Be an Upstander

সাইবার বুলিং বন্ধ করো — প্রতিরোধকারী হও [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

Virtue: Courage + Kindness | সাহস + দয়া [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

**Learning Objective:** Students will identify cyberbullying and know 3 safe steps to respond when they see it or experience it.

*[FOUNDER INPUT REQUIRED: Please review this cyberbullying scenario for cultural appropriateness and alignment with Blu Foundation's safeguarding protocols before printing. In particular, confirm: (1) the WhatsApp group scenario is contextually appropriate for this age group; (2) the guidance to tell a trusted teacher aligns with school-level reporting structures; (3) the note to parents about not confiscating devices is consistent with Blu Foundation's parent communication stance.]*

## The Story: The Group That Went Quiet

It started with one photo.

Someone had found an old, embarrassing photo of a classmate — a girl named Dina — from a school trip three years earlier. Dina's hair had been messy and she was making a strange face. Someone shared it in the class WhatsApp group with a cruel caption.

Within an hour, twelve students had added laughing emojis. A few added their own comments. Some were not sure if it was okay but didn't want to say anything. They just went quiet.

Dina saw the message at 9 PM. She didn't sleep that night.

The next morning, she came to school with her eyes down. She sat alone at break. She told her mother she had a headache. She was afraid to look at her phone.

In the group, Mitu had not laughed. She had watched the messages come in, heart beating fast, unsure what to do. Then she typed:

*"This isn't funny. Please stop. Delete the photo."*

Three students responded immediately: *"agreed"* and *"yeah this is too much."* The cruelty stopped. The thread went quiet.

After school, Mitu sent Dina a private message: *"I'm really sorry that happened. You didn't deserve that. Are you okay?"*

She also told Ms Fahmida the next day.

Dina didn't feel better immediately. But she felt less alone. And the bullying didn't continue.

Research confirms what Dina experienced: students who are bullied often suffer academic decline, emotional distress, and withdrawal from school and social life [SOURCE\_BD\_10]. But when one person speaks up — even one — it changes the situation.

## What Is Cyberbullying?

Cyberbullying is when someone uses technology — phones, apps, social media, messaging groups — to hurt, embarrass, threaten, or repeatedly target another person.

It includes:

- Sending mean or threatening messages
- Sharing embarrassing photos or videos without permission
- Spreading rumours online
- Leaving someone out of online groups on purpose to hurt them
- Impersonating someone online to get them in trouble

**Cyberbullying is not:**

- A disagreement between friends
- One unkind message that was apologised for
- Honest feedback that feels uncomfortable

## Bystander vs. Upstander

|                      | Bystander                                               | Upstander                                                  |
|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Sees bullying</b> | Does nothing                                            | Does something safe to help                                |
| <b>Thinks</b>        | "It's not my business" / "I don't want to get involved" | "This is wrong and I have the power to help"               |
| <b>Result</b>        | Bullying continues — silence is read as permission      | Bullying often stops — one voice can shift the whole group |

Being an upstander does not mean putting yourself in danger. You don't have to confront the bully directly if it doesn't feel safe. There are many ways to help.

## 3 Steps If You See Cyberbullying

**Step 1: Do not share, like, or add to the hurtful content.** Your engagement — even a "haha" — tells the bully that what they did is acceptable. Withhold it.

**Step 2: Send the person being bullied a private message of support.** You don't need to say much. *"I saw what happened. That wasn't okay. I'm here if you need a friend."* This message can change how someone's night goes.

**Step 3: Tell a trusted adult — a teacher or a parent.** This is not "telling tales." Telling a trusted adult about bullying is an act of protection. It takes courage. You are not getting someone in trouble; you are getting someone help.

## 3 Steps If Cyberbullying Is Happening to You

**Step 1: Do not respond in anger.** An angry response gives the bully attention, which is often what they want. It can also escalate the situation. Take a breath. Step away from the screen.

**Step 2: Screenshot and save the evidence.** Before you block or delete, take a screenshot. Evidence matters when you report.

**Step 3: Tell a trusted adult immediately.** You do not have to handle this alone. A parent, teacher, school counsellor, or other trusted adult can help. The sooner you tell, the sooner it stops.

## My Commitment

*"I will be an upstander — not a bystander.*

*If I see someone being hurt online, I will not stay silent. I will do something safe to help — even if it is just one kind message to the person who was hurt, or one conversation with a trusted adult.*

*I promise not to share, like, or add to content that hurts someone."*

**Name:** \_\_\_\_\_ **Date:** \_\_\_\_\_

## Teacher Notes — Chapter 5

**Before reading the story:** Ask: *"Have you ever seen something unkind happening — online or in person — and felt unsure whether to say something?"* Pause. *"What stopped you?"* This question — not requiring personal disclosure — opens the space for honest reflection about the bystander instinct.

**After the story:** Ask: *"What would have happened if Mitu hadn't typed anything? Would the bullying have continued?"* Discuss how silence can be read as permission.

**Upstander Pledge (strongly recommended):** Create a physical or digital class "Upstander Pledge." Design it together. All students sign. Display it in the classroom. This creates collective accountability.

**Roleplay:** Roleplay the group chat scenario using a shared whiteboard or paper — have students physically write in a "group chat." Let one student play the role of Mitu (the upstander). Debrief: *"What did it feel like to be the first one to speak up?"*

**Important safeguarding note:** If a student discloses current or past cyberbullying during this session, follow your school's safeguarding protocols. Create a safe, private way for students to speak to you after class if they need to. Consider placing a small note on each desk: *"If something in this story feels personal to you, you can write me a note — you don't have to share out loud."*

**Assessment checkpoint:** Three steps if you see cyberbullying + three steps if it's happening to you — students list from memory, then verify against the text.

## Parent Corner [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]

[NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION — English below for translation]

This week, your child learned about cyberbullying — what it is, how to be an upstander when they see it, and what to do if it happens to them.

The most important thing you can do as a parent:

If your child tells you about online bullying — whether it is happening to them or to someone else — **take it seriously.** Listen first. Validate their feelings. Then take action together.

Please **do not** take away their device as a first response. If your child feels that telling you about online problems will result in losing their phone, they will stop telling you. The goal is for them to trust you enough to come to you when it matters most.

If cyberbullying is happening to your child, contact the school together. Document the evidence. And reassure your child: *"This is not your fault. You did the right thing by telling me."*

## END OF BOOK

## My Communication Pledge

*This page belongs to:*

**My name is:** \_\_\_\_\_

**My class is:** \_\_\_\_\_

**The date I signed this pledge:** \_\_\_\_\_

*I, \_\_\_\_\_, promise to:*

***Speak honestly AND kindly.*** *I will say what I mean without hurting the people I say it to. I will use assertive words — not aggressive, not silent.*

***Listen to understand, not just to reply.*** *I will put away my distractions. I will give people my full attention. I will hear what they are really saying before I respond.*

***Be responsible and respectful online.*** *Before I post, I will ask: Is it true? Is it kind? Is it necessary? I will always*

ask permission before sharing photos or videos of others.

**Stand up for others when I see cruelty.** I will not stay silent when someone is being hurt. I will be an upstander. I will do something safe — even if it is small.

**Apologise when I make mistakes.** I will make mistakes. We all do. What matters is that I take responsibility, say sorry, and try again.

Signed: \_\_\_\_\_

Keep this page. Read it again when you need a reminder of who you choose to be.

# Glossary

| English Term       | Bengali [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION] | Definition                                                                                                              |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Assertive          | [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]         | Speaking honestly and kindly — saying what you mean without hurting others or going silent                              |
| Aggressive         | [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]         | Speaking in a way that is loud, harsh, dismissive, or hurtful — prioritising winning over the other person              |
| Passive            | [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]         | Choosing not to speak up even when you have something important to say, often out of fear or habit                      |
| Empathic listening | [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]         | Listening with full attention, without distractions or judgement, in order to truly understand how another person feels |
| Digital footprint  | [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]         | The trail of information — posts, messages, comments, photos — you leave behind online                                  |
| Online permanence  | [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]         | The fact that once something is posted online, it is very hard to fully delete or control where it goes                 |
| Digital etiquette  | [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]         | The rules of polite, respectful behaviour when communicating online or by phone                                         |
| Cyberbullying      | [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION]         | Using technology — phones, apps, messaging groups — to hurt, embarrass, threaten, or repeatedly target another person   |

|                |                             |                                                                                                      |
|----------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Bystander      | [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION] | A person who sees something wrong happening but does nothing                                         |
| Upstander      | [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION] | A person who sees something wrong happening and takes safe, constructive action to help              |
| Empathy        | [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION] | The ability to understand and share the feelings of another person                                   |
| Permission     | [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION] | Agreement freely given by someone before their photo, words, or personal information is shared       |
| Reflect back   | [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION] | Repeating what you heard someone say, in your own words, to check that you understood them correctly |
| Distraction    | [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION] | Something that takes your attention away from the person or task in front of you                     |
| Responsibility | [NEEDS BENGALI TRANSLATION] | Owning your choices and their consequences — online and offline                                      |

## Source Notes (Curriculum Team)

*The following source codes are used in this textbook. Full bibliography and access links are maintained in the Blu Foundation Phase 2 Curriculum Master Reference Document. Please contact the curriculum lead for the complete citation file.*

**[SOURCE\_BD\_10]** Used in: Chapter 5 (cyberbullying consequences — academic decline, mental distress, social withdrawal) Context: Research on the consequences of school-based and online bullying among students in Bangladesh.

**[SOURCE\_BD\_13]** Used in: Chapter 3 (social media behavioural impact on Bangladeshi students) Context: Study indicating that social media has more negative than positive behavioural impacts on secondary students in Bangladesh.

**[SOURCE\_BD\_14]** Used in: Chapter 3 (TikTok/YouTube use and behavioural outcomes) Context: Survey of 231 Bangladeshi students showing correlations between heavy TikTok/YouTube use and behaviours including elder disobedience and antisocial conduct.

**[SOURCE\_BD\_16]** Used in: Chapter 4 (algorithms and Gen Z behavioural norms) Context: Research on how social media algorithms shape what young people perceive as normal behaviour, and how platforms can be used to redefine those norms positively.

**[SOURCE\_GL\_01]** Used in: Curriculum framework alignment Context: Global SEL framework — relationship skills competency domain.

**[SOURCE\_GL\_03]** Used in: Curriculum framework alignment Context: Global SEL framework — responsible decision-making competency domain.

**Religious reference:** Quran, Surah An-Nisa (4:63) — referenced in Chapter 1 as an Islamic grounding for assertive, truth-with-kindness communication. Translation note: "...and speak to them words that penetrate their souls." The curriculum team notes this reference is used as an inclusive ethical anchor and should be presented with sensitivity to students of all faiths in multi-faith classrooms.

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*End of BLU\_D08 Class 4 Textbook — Version 1.0 DRAFT*

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